

Making yourself a second Thundermail calendar

Thunderbird cannot create one and the website cannot either. This can.

Thunderbird's **New Calendar** only *subscribes* to calendars your server already has — it never asks the server to make one. Thundermail's website has no way to make one either. So if you want a second calendar, for a project or a family or a ticket you are reproducing, there is currently no way to get one by clicking.

This is a small script that sends the one request that creates it. **You will need a terminal.** Afterwards you subscribe to it in Thunderbird in the normal way.

1 What you need

- **An app password** — not the password you type into Thunderbird, which uses a sign-in method this cannot. Thundermail's instructions for making one: [Create an App Password](https://support.tb.pro/hc/articles/46805020320275-Create-an-App-Password)
`https://support.tb.pro/hc/articles/46805020320275-Create-an-App-Password`
- **The address of your calendars.** In Thunderbird, right-click a calendar, choose **Properties**, and copy **Location**. Then delete the last part, so it ends just after your address. An `@` is written `%40`.
- **The tools:** `git clone https://github.com/thunderbird/desktop-support-tools`, and `uv`, which runs them.

2 See what you already have

```
export CALDAV_USER='you@thundermail.com'
CAL_HOME='https://mail.thundermail.com/dav/cal/you%40thundermail.com/'

uv run caldav_list_calendars.py "$CAL_HOME" --all
```

It asks for your app password and lists your calendars with their addresses, marking the default one. Worth doing first: the next step refuses to reuse a name or an address you already have, and this is how you see what those are.

3 Make the calendar

```
uv run caldav_make_calendar.py "$CAL_HOME" "Book club"
```

The name is what Thunderbird will show. The address is worked out from it — `Book club` becomes `.../book-club/` — and the script prints it, because that is what you will subscribe to and what you would use later to remove it. Add `--confirm` to be shown the address and asked before anything is sent, or `--path` to choose the address yourself.

The address is decided here and never changes again. If you rename the calendar later, only the friendly name changes: a calendar created as "Book club" answers at `.../book-club/` for ever, whatever it ends up being called. That is why it is worth a moment's thought now, and why nothing breaks when you rename it afterwards.

Nothing is overwritten. If a calendar is already at that address, or already going by that name, the script says so and sends nothing — two calendars with one name cannot be told apart in Thunderbird's list.

4 Add it to Thunderbird

Making a calendar on the server does not put it in your client. In Thunderbird: **New Calendar** → **On the Network**, which lists what your account has, and pick the one you just made. It should be there immediately; if it is not, quit Thunderbird and reopen it.

5 Removing it again

```
uv run caldav_delete_calendars.py "$CAL_HOME" --only "Book club"          # shows, changes nothing
uv run caldav_delete_calendars.py "$CAL_HOME" --only "Book club" --delete
```

Deleting takes everything in it. There is no undo, no trash and no confirmation at the server: one request and the calendar and its events are gone. Run it without `--delete` first and read what it says it would do. Your **default** calendar cannot be deleted at all, which is deliberate — the server refuses, and so does the script.

Afterwards, remove it from Thunderbird too: it keeps its own copy and will go on showing a calendar the server no longer has.

If something goes wrong

- **"The server would not accept that username and password"** — almost always an account password where an app password is needed; see [Create an App Password](#).
- **"No calendars under ..."** — the address you gave is one calendar rather than all of them. Take the last part off it.
- **"... is already there"** or **"already has a calendar called ..."** — pick a different name, or give `--path` to choose a different address.
- **"the account is out of space"** — Thundermail says no; nothing was created.
- **It worked but Thunderbird cannot see it** — check with the listing command in step 2. If the server has it and Thunderbird does not, restart Thunderbird.

One thing worth knowing about why this exists: that Thunderbird cannot create a calendar is a gap rather than a decision, and it is filed as a bug. The day it is fixed, this script stops being necessary — which would be the better outcome.